

Move To Perform With Exercise & Physical Activity

Myth Busting

- Work and physical activity are mutually exclusive. We know that this is not true because when we give ourselves permission to move away from our desks for a quick walk or stretch then we benefit from a sensation called task reorientation when we return to our work. We see it with fresh and clearer eyes.
- In the module you will also find a routine you can do with minimal space, no equipment and without getting sweaty – much used reasons for sedentarism in the workplace.
- Be aware of the figures – 5,000 steps or less per day is sedentary behaviour and done often results in a sedentary lifestyle which has been linked with 35 chronic health conditions. If you walk to work or part of the way for 5-days of the week then how many steps will you add? Remember also that 75-minutes per week of brisk walking could add almost two more years to your life. Get moving!

Habit Loop

- Relying on willpower and motivation for exercise, physical activity and movement is a bad idea. These are finite. Creating it into a habit like washing your teeth is a much better strategy for your health.
- Remember the 3 r's – reminder, routine and rewards. Reminder could be something as simple as a calendar reminder at 10.55AM to get up from your desk and do a 5-minute stretch. Routine is referring to what you will do e.g. what stretching movements, what little stroll etc. Use the videos in the module for lots of ideas on this part. Lastly, appreciate the reward of completing the habit it e.g. feeling spritelier and less tense after the stretch break.

Make It Fun

- Too many people have the opinion that exercise has to be long and arduous to reap the rewards which is rubbish. As little as 20-minutes is enough to get much of the benefit from a workout.
- What exercise, movement or physical activities do you enjoy? This is the most important question. Basing exercise around what you enjoy makes it infinitely easier. If you enjoy very little then it may be an idea to pair stretching or a treadmill run with a TV programme that you like so it feels like less of a chore.
- Lastly, find accountability to keep you consistent. It's much harder to give up on a friend or coach than when it is just yourself. Exercise also offers many camaraderie building opportunities.

Silly Little Efforts Make A Big Difference

- Do not underestimate the power of mini habits when it comes to your health. 3-minutes of stretching your hips in the morning may appear like very little but could result in a lot more pleasure and comfort as you get older and can still engage in physical activities.
- What about building a new habit that you see the elevator as a death trap and decide to take the stairs the majority of the time from here on?

